

What is your current role? What do you work as?

I am a mid-level developer.

And how long have you been working with software development?

I think it will be approximately 6 years.

And which AI tools do you use in your work for software development?

Yeah, currently I am using Cursor more. Yeah, inside Cursor, several LLMs. I also use some other support ones, right? I use Copilot for support. Yeah, but very little, actually. I think today I solve everything inside Cursor in general, okay?

And how often do you use these tools?

Yeah, daily. Quite a lot, actually. Yeah, I thought more about the development part of the day, right? But there are other tools that we use a lot, which are from AWS, okay? There are some there, mainly related to Bedrock from AWS, we use it a lot. Yeah, we build on top of this Bedrock structure,

And in which types of activity do you usually use AI?

Yeah, in development, in general, right, in the case of programming, architecture design, yeah, I use AI to support not only having a view of the design, but also to design, to make the design itself. Right? So I end up gaining a lot in productivity in that, which is something that we end up losing time on. Yeah, in general I think it is more that, like, sometimes documentation, right? We end up documenting a lot of things, but I think the main thing, really, in daily use is programming.

And can you describe a recent case in which you used AI to perform some development activity.

Yeah, thinking from the beginning to the end.

Actually, recently, like, today I am doing this, right? I am using it to develop a system, actually, an entire back-end for a screen that will go to the front there, which is related to an insight system generated by AI. So, I am going to use, I am using AI to develop a system that generates insights made by AI. So, very high productivity, okay? So I am doing everything very fast, like, something that would probably take, I don't know, maybe a month to do by hand. I am doing it in around one week.

And how do you receive what needs to be done, right?

Actually, they are tasks like that, but since I am doing, I am working a lot in this AI area there, a lot of things we are doing in Go Horse there, we go, there is an elucidation of the idea and I discuss it with the PO. And sometimes I am even going beyond the story, right? She cannot keep up with writing the story, at the speed that I have been developing. So, a lot of things have kind of been according to the need there, we create with AI and the stories cannot keep up, you know? Because today the PO is not using AI in the writing, in the stories, in the development, and I end up not stopping to do this, this writing for her because of productivity. I prefer to validate the idea first.

And when you are going to develop, how do you put it to the AI? Do you have some process, some methodology that you follow, or do you go saying like: "Ah, AI, make this functionality here for me".

I have a methodology, it is a framework that we use on top of AI inside Cursor called BMad. We use this framework as support from the elucidation of the idea, to the creation of the PRD, then from there we do the development. That is when it is more, a little more complex. When it is simpler, we can go faster straight to the goal, right? Like a correction, something, we go straight to the goal by just asking there.

Do you create these PRDs or not?

I create the PRD, so I take all the context that I think will be involved in that story, so sometimes it is not a project, right? Sometimes there are several projects that make sense to be there in the AI context, I try to guide it on the main points that I am dealing with, right? If it is a story from an existing project, then I try to give it a more specific context, for it to be more objective, spend fewer tokens and also be faster, right? Then with that, I generate a very complete PRD, then I review this PRD and most of the time it needs to have a very complete review because it does not always come out the correct way and then I use the LLM itself to be able to make the corrections to the PRD, right? So I see the points that I think are not adequate, I tell it, it keeps correcting until I have a PRD that I consider ideal.

And from this PRD, does it already do the entire construction of the code? Or is there some stage there between this process?

It depends on the complexity, it depends on the complexity. Then, if it is a project, for example, new or that I see is a very big change, I usually put some more steps in the way. So, I can ask it to create the stories for me. So, look, create the stories that I can review in smaller points, see if it makes sense. After the stories are created, I usually ask for another review on top of the stories, right? I review manually, but I ask it to review too, because sometimes I may have let something pass. And from the stories I start the development part. Then depending on the size, either I go story by story there, right? Or then I already say: man, go there, I activate Elo Mode there and until it finishes.

So you basically use it as support? You are always reviewing, you do not let it do it directly?

I do not let it do it directly. I always review, but like, I practically stopped writing code. It is very rare for me to write code. I take and review the code and then if everything is right, okay, if it is not, I ask it to correct it. I no longer make corrections in code. Not even specific ones, because I believe that this generates more bugs than letting it correct. Because sometimes a point that you change may be related to another point there that you do not have visibility of and it is in the LLM's context. So I do everything through LLM today. Basically I just keep doing code review for it. It does it and I keep analyzing. Right? So, I do code review for it and it also does code review for itself. So, we stay like this, like, I am more of a reviewer nowadays than a developer.

And does it do the tests too?

It does the tests too. The tests it does, depending on the, it is because like, if I ask for very high test coverage, it usually kind of cheats there, it makes the tests kind of just to pass, right? So, usually I have to leave a slightly more demanding prompt for tests, if the coverage is very high and I have to review a little more rigorously to see if the tests make sense, because many times, right, they are tests like that that do not even make sense to exist. It is very simple, just to increase the coverage.

So, just to confirm, for you to make a change nowadays in the code, you have to tell the AI to make this change. It is not you who goes directly there and changes it. Exactly. Today I am using it to do it.

And, like, the use of AI, how did it change the way you work?

It changed completely. Because productivity increased a lot. So, today we do not waste time with small corrections, so, you do not have to open, search, nothing, you put the code, you know the source of the problem, right? So you just ask the LLM to review, and finding it there, making sense, it already corrects it. So we gain a lot in productivity to solve small problems and more complex things, we gained a, maybe, reasoning partner, right? We can develop the ideas better, manage to design the flows with greater ease, productivity, display these flows in a more complete way. But I think the main thing is that today I do not code, like, I only talk to the LLM really. And basically it became even a little more tedious, like, but on the other hand it became more productive. We sometimes stay with several Cursor windows open there, each one doing something, so we keep doing tests in parallel. So I think it changed a little in that sense and it also changed a little in the expectation of whoever will receive the product too, right? Because today things end up coming out faster. Ah, maybe the business view is that we can also do things, deliver faster, but there is all this review part that is still tedious, right? So, we are still responsible for what goes up, right? We do not pass the responsibility to the LLM. So, although we can do several things at the same time, we have this difficulty of having to review everything afterward. So, this thing, the rush wanting to have the product quickly ends up being able to lose in code quality, you know?

And you commented about BMad? Do you usually follow its whole process of making requirements, code, or sometimes you, ah, for this activity here I think this stage is not needed or for this one it needs to follow all these stages. Do you have this or not?

I do, but it depends. In a way like, on a daily basis, in general, like, if the PRD is well written or if it is a very small change that does not even need a PRD, you can use it, There is the part mode there in BMAD. This part mode self-manages, right, the agents. And it works well in most cases, at least in my use case. For more complex projects, maybe it does not work very well, but I think if the PRD is well done, yeah, very correct, if the idea is well placed, reviewed, most of the time the part mode solves it by itself.

And nowadays the PRD, because you commented that the PO usually is not using it, right? You are the one building it. Do you just send the context there to the LLM, it assembles this PRD or do you make some adjustment there, ask it to put it into a template?

No, I follow the template that is usually already inside BMAD, right? It ends up generating inside a ready-made PRD template, right? That has the prompt there inside for it. But yeah, in general I have a good discussion with the PO before the idea, but since I, the idea in general of the technical part of the back, of the AI flows that will be made comes from me. Yeah, so I just try to meet the business requirements that the PO asks for, but in the end the PRD is written by me based on the technical notion, right? And the business part I get with the, with the PO, I negotiate with her, what is expected and even for me to know what I am going to develop on the technical side and put in the PRD.

And how was your process of starting to use AI? Do you think you had ease, difficulty?

No, I think I had a lot of ease, because it is very intuitive and actually I started using it before, right, I did not have contact with Cursor. I only used ChatGPT. I used it in daily life like that, right? So, I think there I was already researching, already getting informed. Then, the part inside AWS, I had

already done, studied a lot, even before when it was still new, right? We did not even have half of what AWS has today in AI, I was already looking. So, when Cursor comes out, for example, which is what we use most on a daily basis, for me it was like, man, now it is just, it is just reading document, just keep reading document. And then it became easy, like, generally speaking, a lot, a lot of things that we wasted time on, configuration, complexity. It became very easy and then I did not have, actually, the problem was that it became even too easy and then we end up taking on a lot of activity, we end up being charged a little more and then a little more is expected. And despite that, it seems that the work did not decrease, actually the work even seems to have increased, you know?

So, the responsibilities before what I needed, for example, to call an architect, call another dev to ask for some support, yeah, something like that, today I no longer need to, you know? Today I rarely need an architect, actually today I do the role of the PO, of the architect, of the dev, of the tester, so yeah, and that is how it ended up, you know? So, it is more or less that.

But despite that, do you still prefer to work with it or as it was before?

No, I prefer to work with it, right? Because I think that actually, this difficulty that exists of this excess work and this, because it ended up that before we had each role very well defined, right? Today with AI, we kind of start to see that we are already doing roles that are not ours, right? And like, the ideal is for this not to make sense, right? Like, despite having AI, each person does their part. The architect uses AI for him, the PO for hers and the dev would only put it in the code. But I understand that the job market is not yet adapted to this, you know? They do not understand yet that AI is taking on all this, actually, the dev is taking on all this responsibility. And then I think this has been bad. I think this is being very bad because of this lack of definition.

And we end up taking on more responsibility than, in fact, we are in the role. People come today to ask me about architecture, I am not an architect, so, we end up doing more than we should with it. But I would not change back to what it was before, you know? I think the market has to adapt a little better to this.

And what do you think is still missing to use AI better in development? Do you have any practice, any guidance, anything you want to report to improve its use, in this software development context?

Yeah, actually, I think some standards are missing, yes. I think everything is very new for a lot of people, right? Today I think people are even like that, right? If we take some AWS resources, for example, there is a lot that is poorly documented, there is a lot that seems like they threw it there without being 100% working, and this is us talking about a giant company, right? And then, within the dev context, maybe standardization is missing, I think BMAD already brings a way of standardizing some flows. But in general it has worked well, so I think the big difficulty really is this division of roles, I think that is what has been missing the most, like, as a standard really, is understanding that, man, the PO will have to do their part there. So they have to have a license, the architect has to have his license, the dev has to have his. Yeah, but like, it is very complicated, I would not know how to answer either, because for the dev it would be extremely boring, to just, take the ready documents, put them in the code. So, I do not know yet. I do not know if that gives you a complete answer. But like, for me, for me what is missing is more standardization, like, of use, of naming the roles, right? Today I use it my way, the way I want. There is no standard that I follow, I have BMAD there, which I can follow or not. And then I have been doing all of this, right? From ideation to the final product.

How does the code review process work? What do you think is more interesting, doing it yourself or another person?

The problem with doing your own code review, but whoever is going to do the code review will do the code review with AI. So, maybe like, it makes sense, because in the end we are the ones who tell the AI to do it. So, it depends a lot on the context that you will give the AI to do that there. And sometimes we are doing our own code review, sometimes we fail to validate something, ask AI to validate something, mainly related to the business rule, not semantic issues there in the code, right? So, I think the main problem with us doing our own code review is that we are very biased in our own code, in the request itself that we made to the AI, you know? So, I think the ideal would be to have a process of someone doing it even with AI, but having that person's context, you know?